



Off-colour: Stephen Curry and LeBron James had forgettable seasons with their respective teams, Golden State Warriors and Los Angeles Lakers. AFP

history with LeBron and Bronny James may reap some rewards in the upcoming season, but only time will tell.

Interestingly, the defending champion Denver Nuggets, which knocked out the Lakers this time around, was ousted by the Minnesota Timberwolves in the Conference semifinals.

Over in San Francisco, while point guard Stephen Curry received the Clutch Player of the Year Award, his team, the Golden State Warriors, had a season to forget. The six-time champion failed to make the Playoffs after losing to Sacramento Kings in the Play-in tournament.

The Warriors could have just looked back at the 2021-22 season, when it clinched its sixth title, for some answers. Perhaps it relied too much on Curry, who finished his 15th season as a Warrior. The next best points-per-game to Curry's 26.4 was Klay Thompson's 17.9.



Mr. Consistent delivers again

Nikola Jokic (**left**) of Serbia was adjudged the Most Valuable Player of the regular season in 2024. This was his third MVP title, with the other two coming in 2021 and 2022.

Jokic has been with the Denver Nuggets since the 2015-16 season and has shown a steady rise in his scoring rate.

In the 2018-19 season, he crossed 1500 points during the regular season. Over the past four seasons, he has had two 2000+ points seasons – 2021-22 and 2023-24. In the year he helped his team win its maiden NBA title, Jokic amassed 1690 points with an average of 24.5.

While Jokic and his team couldn't defend its title against an in-form Celtics, it will hope to bank on the Serbian star to lead by example next season and clinch its second title in three years.